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EDUCATION

Post-Graduate Diploma in Rural Management, Institute of Rural Management (IRMA), 1991
Bachelor of Science (B. Sc.) Statistics & Operations Research, Mumbai University, April 1987

WORK EXPERIENCE

32 years in origin & international commodity sourcing, production planning, category mgmt., cost savings, systems & processes, and global e-procurement & trade. Recent assignments in leadership roles, business partnering, driving change management.

PERFETTI VAN MELLE

Retired as Process Excellence Lead – Procurement - Digital Transformation Project SAP S/4 HANA: Jun 2022 to Dec 2023.

- (a) Led a team of Global Process Owners and Business Analysts, collaborated with cross-functional leads & teams, system integration & consulting partners, liaised with internal stakeholders.
- (b) Analyzed, re-designed & standardized current ways-of-working, Business & SAP processes, Key Design Decisions on optimal future processes, Master Data Mgmt., Blueprinting future processes and designs.
- (c) Drove seamless implementation & Go-Live roll-out in Benelux (Nov 2023); Data Migration, System Integration / User Acceptance Testing, Fit / Gap Analysis, Business & Technical Cutover, Go-Live Prep for rest of Europe in 2024.
- (d) e-Procurement Tool: Led & drove vendor identification, testing, evaluation & shortlisting, final recommendation.

Regional Procurement Director South Asia Middle East & Africa: Jan 2018 to May 2022.

- (a) Managed direct materials spend of €150Mn+ for India, B'desh, Nigeria & Sri Lanka for 6 mfg sites & 350+ vendors. Drove mgmt. of change – global / regional structure, ways-of-working, centralized procurement.
- (b) Co-developed & implemented robust sourcing strategies, extended best-practices. Supported supplier capacities, contract coverage & compliance, un-interrupted supplies, risk mgmt. practices, single-supplier risk mitigation.
- (c) Designed and implemented go-to-market intelligence-based strategies for regional categories.
- (d) Collaborated with internal stakeholders to build & deliver a pipeline of cost-saving, optimization & productivity-enhancing projects, single-supplier risk mgmt., track delivery and course-correct. Drove continuous ideation.
- (e) Supplier Relationship & Performance Mgmt. Project Mgmt. approach for savings / avoidance projects tracking.
- (f) Made & delivered on Annual Budgets, Cost-Saving and Cost-Avoidance targets, PPV, inflation & risk mitigation. "Business partner" to region & country while driving & implementing global systems & practices.

GENERAL MILLS INDIA, MUMBAI

Sourcing Regional Category Procurement Leader – Grains & Flours – AMEA Region: Sep 2015 to Dec 2017.

- (a) Overall sourcing leadership role for all Grains and Flours categories across India and MEA markets. Developed & implemented Category Strategy; Annual Budget plan & conformance responsibility.
- (b) Annual volumes & spend managed: India – 150,000MT Wheat & Wheat Flour (\$75Mn), other minor Flours, Grains, Semolina, Rice / Chickpea Flours (Rs2500Mn/\$36Mn) and MEA - 6,500MT Wheat Flours (\$5Mn). Category-wise single largest spend in both markets; India category spend over 50% of direct material spend. Allied risk mgmt.
- (c) Managed origin sourcing wheat in India. Spend managed Rs200cr/\$3Mn. Led team of 2 direct reports & ~30 temp buying-season hires. Team building, functional capabilities, price / volume targets, SC interdependence.
- (d) Collaborated with R&D on new varieties, geographies, suppliers, & cost-avoidance / other projects. Successfully led and implemented new wheat variety / sourcing geography related saving of \$0.5Mn.

Head Strategic Sourcing & Procurement for India business: Sep 2012 to Aug 2015.

- (a) Sourcing leadership of RM/PM categories – development & delivery of annual financial plan & cost-savings targets, and category sourcing & position-building strategies for an annual direct spend of Rs350cr/\$45Mn.
- (b) Led team of 3 Category Buyers for diverse categories – Wheat / Flours, Flexible, Rigid & Fibre Packaging, agri-commodities – Sugar, Dairy, Fats, Spices, value-added ingredients. Developed & implemented category strategies.
- (c) Drove cross-market e-sourcing/cost-saving Projects on Cocoa, Flexible Packaging and Strategic position-building on Wheat, Sugar and Cocoa. Collaborated with US and EU/AU on e-projects.
- (d) Sourcing & supply localization for key value-added ingredients of Nature Valley granola bars: Oats, Peanuts, Raisins, Cashew, Almonds, Jaggery
- (e) Drove supply base capability evaluation, design & implement supplier performance review systems & relationship management, led & negotiate supply agreements, adopt best practices.

TRITON GROUP, MUMBAI

Trades seafood, meat and poultry. Business footprint covers west & central Africa, MENA, South Africa, east Europe, and India. India operations include a seafood processing plant just outside Mumbai.

Head Trade – New Markets: Feb 2010 to Aug 2012.

- (a) Built & led a 5-trader team in supplier / product identification, market scan, supplier development & relationship building for seafood markets of South Africa, DR Congo, UAE, Poland, Romania, Egypt & India.
- (b) Identified, sourced & traded / shipped seafood products over 5000mt valued at over \$10Mn.

GRAVISS FOOD SOLUTIONS, MUMBAI

A master-franchise group across 3 verticals. Foods (Baskin Robbin's and Rich's Whip Topping Products USA), Hospitality – Mayfair Banquets and the InterContinental Hotel, Mumbai) and Pure Ice Cream Dubai – Kwaliti ice cream.

Group VP Supply Chain & Commercial: Feb 2009 to Jan 2010.

- (a) Drive cost-saving initiatives for company-wide direct spend. Budgeting & Variance review – purchase & inventory management. Annual Contracts. developed, executed commodity sourcing strategies; advised best-buy.
- (b) Direct responsibility: HPKO & Sugar – each 1500mt/year and NFDM & Glucose each 600mt/year. Spend \$20+Mn.

SUBHIKSHA TRADING SERVICES LTD, INDORE / PUNE

One of the earliest modern trade start-ups in the convenience store & discount chain format; had grown to 1200+ stores in 10 states in 3 verticals (supermarket, mobile phones & pharmaceuticals).

Asst Vice-President Agri-commodity Sourcing - Aug 2006 to Feb 2009.

- (a) Sourced cereals, staples, pulses and other grocery category items. Contracted directly with millers / producers.
- (b) Special Projects - direct sourcing of sugar, cereals / grains & pulses; sourcing de-layering, value chain analysis.
- (c) Supply value chain research for nuts (peanuts, almonds, cashew), raisins, dehydrated fruit / vegetable products.

DABUR INDIA, DELHI / DABUR NEPAL, KATHMANDU

Head Purchase & Supply Chain Dabur Nepal - May 2003 to Aug 2006.

- (a) Annual spend \$40Mn; direct responsibility \$30Mn, including native agri-products / medicinal plants.
- (b) Strategic sourcing of high-value commodities: Veg Oils (Coconut, Palm, Canola), Spices (Pepper, Cumin, Cassia, Cardamom) Chemicals (Camphor, Citric Acid); from China, Turkey, Guatemala, Vietnam, Indonesia, Malaysia.
- (c) Production planning/replenishment, inventory mgmt. & new product planning co-ordination for Nepal business.
- (d) Team Member - Baan ERP implementation from June 2003. Led business process & form design for Procurement.

Head Purchase Sahibabad Plant - Jul 2002 to Apr 2003.

- (a) Managed purchase spends \$1.5Mn covering over 750 RM / PM items and Guar purchase from Feb 2003.
- (b) On-time delivery, Quality conformance, PPV & Inventory. Co-ordination for centralized purchased items.

Manager Supply Chain Production Planning & Replenishment – Family Products Division - Jun 2000 to July 2002.

- (a) Replenishment of 28 CFAs from 15 manufacturing sites (both 3P & own) & inventory management.
- (b) Production planning for 15 sites including Nepal. Team Member Mfg/Pro ERP implementation at 3P mfg sites.

Category Manager Commodity Purchase - Feb 1998 to May 2000.

- (a) Honey – over 10,000mt from Feb 1998 to Aug 1998; Spices, Fruits & Vegetables from Jan 1999.
- (b) Sourcing strategy & execution for Vegetables / Fruit for Pastes / Juice; best-buying / seasonal and make v buy strategies – Lemon, Onion, Ginger, Garlic, Chili pepper – delayering of source to origin, supplier identification & relationship mgmt.
- (c) Baan ERP implementation team – Aug 1999 to May 2000. Led the business process & form design for Procurement.

OLAM NIGERIA Plc

Sourcing Manager - Nov 1995 to Oct 1997.

- (a) Origin-sourcing of 10,000mt Sesame, 20,000mt Cashew & 25,000mt Cocoa.
- (b) Procurement planning, manpower, buying locations & infrastructure, warehousing / receiving / pre-cleaning and land transportation operations, agents & advances monitoring, quality, funds planning, transportation, expense budget & control and routine accounting & reporting.
- (c) Managed funds of over US\$50mn, and all allied risks including collateral-based loans to traders.
- (d) Led a team of 5-7 local direct reports for each season, and around 50 labor managed by them.

RUCHI SOYA INDUSTRIES LIMITED, INDORE

Trading Manager - Jan 1995 to Oct 1995.

- (a) Strategy & execution for oil/oilseeds – soya. Pricing decisions for consumer packs & pre-launch studies for NPDs.

GUJARAT CO-OP OILSEEDS GROWERS' FEDERATION LTD, AHMEDABAD

Trading Executive - Apr 1991 to Dec 1994.

- (a) Annual buying strategy & execution for edible oils & hydrogenated fats mfg & bulk sales of oil processed at member co-op factories. Assisted in mustard/rapeseed/peanut oils/oilseeds, bulk & consumer products trade Rs150cr (\$20Mn).